

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Become a Growing Church

An Inviting Church

A free resource from JesusOnline.

Read or share online: equip.jesonline.com/channels/church/become-growing-church/an-inviting-church

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

An Inviting Church

Become an Inviting Church

Extending invitations and welcoming newcomers with open arms.

Note: This article is written primarily with churches in the Western world in mind. However, the biblical truths it presents apply to all congregations, in every cultural context. We strongly encourage you to thoughtfully adapt and apply these principles to your own local situation and culture.

Every faithful pastor and church leader longs to see their congregation naturally inviting others to join them in worship on Sunday mornings. You have likely encouraged and even exhorted your members to reach out, to be bold in extending invitations, and to welcome newcomers with open arms. This desire flows from a heart aligned with the Great Commission — our Lord's call to make disciples of all nations (Matthew 28:19).

Yet a deeper question remains: *Why would your members eagerly invite others?* What is it about your church family that stirs such genuine excitement in their hearts that they long to share it, confident that others, too, will find blessing and transformation there?

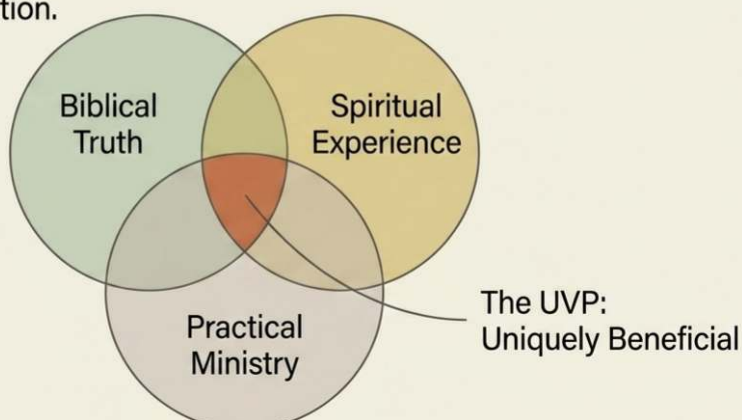
Consider how people recommend a cherished restaurant or a powerful film. They do so not because someone has urged them, but from authentic delight — an experience so meaningful they cannot help but share it. In the same way, invitations to church should spring not primarily from dutiful pressure, but from lives deeply touched by the presence of Christ among His people.

Your Church's Unique Value Proposition

A church's Unique Value Proposition (UVP) is the distinctive combination of biblical truth, spiritual experience, and practical ministry that sets it apart in its community. It answers the heartfelt question: *Why would someone choose this church family over others nearby?* More than marketing language, programs, or doctrinal statements, a faithful UVP flows from prayerful discernment of God's calling, reflects the living reality of Christ among His people, and equips believers to invite others with authentic joy.

Defining your Unique Value Proposition (UVP)

A church's UVP is the distinctive combination of these three elements that sets it apart in its community. It answers the question: *Why would someone choose this church family over others nearby?* Finding this uniquely beneficial identity is one of the strongest motivators for joyful invitation.



Members are naturally most eager to share something when it is uniquely beneficial — something others cannot readily find elsewhere. This uniqueness, whether actual or perceived, is one of the strongest motivators for joyful invitation. What does your church offer that truly cannot be said about other congregations nearby?

Through the resources of JO EQUIP, your church can cultivate a compelling UVP:

- You can become known as a **hope-filled church**, making hope a hallmark of your identity and a beacon of gospel assurance in a despairing world.
- You can be known as a **transformational, teaching church**, utilizing inspiring media and the JO App for sermon follow-up and ongoing discipleship — an integrated approach rare among local congregations.
- You can be identified as a **Total Life Discipleship church**, motivating members to become all God created them to be so they can do all He created them to do. Rather than urging greater self-effort, you lead by repeatedly sharing God's vision for their lives, fostering authentic transformation by the power of the Holy Spirit.

Uniqueness is the strongest motivator for joyful invitation.

	Generic Church Experience	UVP-Driven Church
Member Motivation	Guilt & Obligation	Genuine Excitement
Community Fit	Blends into the background	Distinctly & uniquely beneficial
Invitation Style	Forced and scripted programs	Natural, joyful overflow

Beyond uniqueness, how does your church stand out more than similar churches in your area? With God's guidance, your church can thrive in other crucial areas that promote deeper relationships with Christ and His community.

- Being a **love-demonstrating relational church**, where authentic fellowship reflects the warmth of God's family.
- Being a **Spirit-dependent church**, relying on the Holy Spirit's guidance in every aspect of ministry.

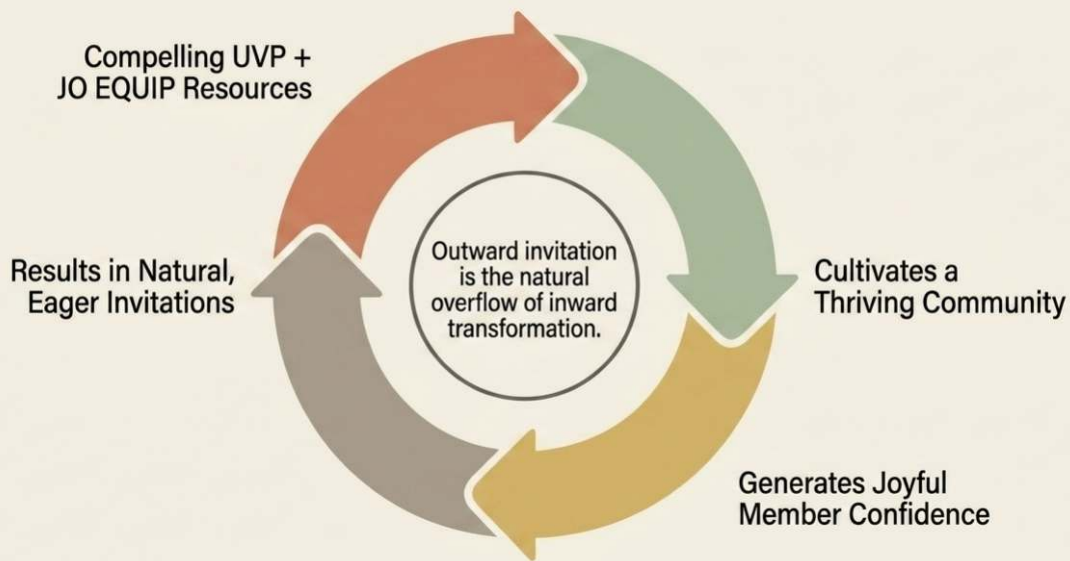
- Being an **intentional worship church**, where gatherings exalt Christ with reverence and joy.
- Being an **online outreach church**, extending the gospel's reach through digital means.
- Being a **Great Commission-focused church**, intentionally advancing Christ's mission in your community and around the world.

When church members personally experience the transformational benefits offered in the Become a Growing Church resources, they will be excited to tell others. Through practical, biblically grounded teachings on identity in Christ, Spirit-led fellowship, purposeful discipleship, and authentic community, they discover renewed hope, clarity of calling, and the joy of belonging to God's family. As these realities reshape their daily lives and shared life together, a natural desire emerges: they long for others to encounter the same life-changing grace.

In such a church, inviting others becomes an overflow of love rather than an assigned task. It echoes the early church, devoted to teaching, fellowship, breaking bread, and prayer, so that "the Lord added to their number day by day those who were being saved" (Acts 2:42-47).

As you reflect on your church's life together, ask the Lord to cultivate an environment so vibrant with His presence — nourished by these equipping resources and marked by distinctive excellence — that your members naturally become inviters. May every gathering be marked by such evident love, truth, and joy in Christ that those who come encounter not merely a service, but the living God who changes lives forever. In this way, your church becomes not only welcoming, but truly inviting — a beacon that draws others into the abundant life found in Jesus.

Healthy internal identity creates natural outward invitation.



Practical Tools and Ways for Church Members to Invite Others

Every pastor and church leader longs to see members naturally inviting others into the life of the church, not out of obligation, but from hearts overflowing with gratitude for what God is doing. As believers experience the transformative power of a hope-filled, Spirit-dependent community nourished by resources like the Become a Growing Church series and JO EQUIP, they become eager to share this grace with friends, neighbors, coworkers, and family. The invitation flows best when it arises from personal testimony and is supported by simple, effective tools.

Here are practical ways members can extend warm, authentic invitations, rooted in prayerful dependence on the Holy Spirit and the unique value your church offers:

1. Share Personal Testimonies of Transformation

- Encourage members to speak naturally about how God has renewed their hope, clarified their identity in Christ, or strengthened their walk through the church's discipleship. A simple story — "I've found renewed purpose through the teachings on who I am in Christ" — often opens doors more powerfully than any program.
- Tie it to JO EQUIP resources: "The JO App has helped me grow daily in God's Word — would you like to check it out with me?"

2. Use Ready-to-Share Digital Tools from JO EQUIP and the JO App

- **JO App:** Members can invite others to download the free app (available on iOS and Android), which offers the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, worship resources, and Total Life Discipleship tools. It serves as an excellent “next step” for seekers exploring the claims of Christ or believers pursuing deeper growth.
- Share links to specific JO App articles or sermon follow-up content via text, email, or social media. The app’s prayer community and evidence-based “Facts for Faith” sections are particularly inviting for those with questions.

3. Practical Invitation Aids

- **Invitation cards or digital invites:** Provide attractive printed cards or shareable graphics highlighting a specific upcoming service, sermon series, or special event. Include a warm welcome message and QR code linking to the church website.
- **Social media and personal networks:** Encourage members to post brief, genuine updates: a photo from worship with a caption about God’s faithfulness, or a direct invitation: “Join us this Sunday — I’d love for you to experience this with me.”
- **Everyday conversations:** Train members in simple, relational approaches, such as asking, “Do you attend church anywhere?” or “I’ve been so encouraged lately — would you ever be interested in coming with me?” Follow up with prayer and genuine care.

4. Relational and Event-Based Invitations

- Invite people first to low-pressure gatherings: a small group, a community outreach event, or a meal following worship.
- Highlight your church’s distinctive strengths — hope-filled identity in Christ, Spirit-led fellowship, or intentional discipleship — so the invitation feels personal and compelling.
- Follow through with hospitality: assign greeters, prepare newcomer packets, and ensure follow-up contact that reflects God’s welcoming love.

Equipping members across the entire invitation spectrum.



5. Prayerful Preparation and Equipping

- Begin with prayer — for specific people God has placed in their lives and for boldness tempered by love.
- Periodically equip the congregation during services: share brief testimonies, distribute tools, and practice simple invitation language together. This builds confidence and reinforces that inviting is a natural outflow of transformed lives.

As members step out in these ways, trusting the Holy Spirit's work, they participate in the Great Commission not as a duty, but as joyful witnesses. The early church grew as ordinary believers lived out their faith in authentic community, and the Lord added daily to their number (Acts 2:47). May your church family, equipped through these resources and marked by distinctive excellence, become a beacon that draws many into the abundant life found in Jesus Christ.

Pastors, consider weaving these practical steps into your ongoing equipping ministry. The Lord who calls His people to invite is faithful to empower them as they do so.

A Promotional Church Business Card

A well-designed business card serves as a simple yet powerful tool for members to extend warm invitations. It captures the church's Unique Value Proposition (UVP) at a glance and reflects the hope and excellence of your ministry. Aim for a clean, professional layout that feels inviting and faith-honoring — perhaps with a subtle cross or open Bible motif, warm earth tones, and ample white space for readability.

Recommended Card Specifications

- **Size:** Standard 3.5" × 2" (horizontal orientation works well).
- **Paper:** Matte or slightly textured cardstock (14–16 pt) for a quality feel.
- **Front side:** Focused and welcoming — church identity and core UVP.
- **Back side:** Informative with bullet points and a clear call to action.
- **Design tips:** Use a readable serif or clean sans-serif font. Include your church logo if available. Add a QR code on the front or back linking to your website or JO App download page. Keep text concise for scannability.

Sample Front Side (Main Identity & UVP)

- **Top:** Church name in larger, elegant font.
- **Center:** A concise byline UVP statement answering, “Why would someone choose your church family over others nearby?”
- **Bottom:** Address, service times, and contact info.
- **Optional:** Subtle tagline or scripture at the footer.

Example text:

[Church Name]

Equipping you to flourish with God's hope in every circumstance.

Sunday Worship: [Time] · [Street Address] · [City, State, ZIP] · [Phone] | [Church Email]

“Join us as we grow together in the grace and knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.” (2 Peter 3:18)

Possible UVP Statements for Your Church Identity

- Equipping you to flourish with God's hope in every circumstance.
- Guiding you to shift from chaos to God's majesty in life's storms.
- Transforming fear into faith through a greater view of God.
- Helping you experience God's victory and strength in difficult times.
- Helping you become all God created you to be.
- Equipping you to do all God created you to do.
- Leading you into Spirit-dependent, grace-based obedience.
- Anchoring you in relationship-centered, love-motivated discipleship.
- Supernatural peace and power found in Christ.
- Rising above trials with unshakable hope in Christ.
- Deeper identity and peace through Spirit-dependent living.
- Lasting life change through transformational teaching.
- Transforming trials into eternal impact through Christ's power.
- Leading you into genuine Christlike transformation.
- Helping you align your life with God's eternal purposes.
- Helping you experience deep heart transformation through God's Word.
- Guiding you to embrace your new identity in Christ.
- Helping you know the full majestic character of God.
- Equipping you to walk daily by the Holy Spirit's power.
- Holistic teaching that transforms head, hands, and heart.
- Anchoring life in God, new identity in Christ, and the Spirit's power.
- Guiding you from God's vision to personal transformation.

Sample Back Side (Uniquenesses, Areas of Excellence & URL)

- **Header:** "What Makes Our Church Family Unique?" or "Discover the Difference".
- **Bullet points:** 3-5, kept brief.
- **Footer:** Church URL, QR code, and a gentle invitation.

Example text:

Experience a Church That Equips You to Flourish

- *Hope-Filled Identity in Christ*
- *Transformational Teaching with JO App*
- *Total-Life Discipleship by God's Vision*
- *Love-Demonstrating Relational Fellowship*
- *Spirit-Dependent Ministry in All Things*

Visit us and experience the abundant life found in Jesus.

[Church Website URL] [QR Code]

Possible Back-Side Bullet Points

Here is a variety of concise, scannable options for the back of your promotional card:

- Hope-Filled Identity in Christ
- Transformational Teaching with JO App
- Total-Life Discipleship by God's Vision
- Love-Demonstrating Relational Fellowship
- Warm Authentic Community in Christ
- Spirit-Dependent Ministry in All Things
- Intentional Worship and Outreach
- Exalting Christ in Worship
- Great Commission Focus with Joy
- Advancing Christ's Mission Together
- Heart Transformation Through God's Word
- Spirit-Led Discipleship and Growth

Distribution Ideas

- Include in newcomer packets, hand out during services, or encourage members to carry a small supply in wallets or cars.
- Pair with relational training: "Share your own story first, then offer the card as a next step."

Such a card becomes more than promotional material — it serves as a quiet witness, reflecting the vibrant, equipping life of your church family. Pray over the design process, asking the Lord to use these simple tools to draw hearts toward Himself.

Register today to become a FREE JesusOnline EQUIPPED Church. [Sign up for updates →](#)

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → jesusonline.com/review

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesusonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesusonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesusonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesusonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping